

Aptly

working name

**Tailor every application.
Be ready when they call.**

A low-friction CV tailoring tool with a memory. Drop a job post and your CV, get the exact changes with one-tap apply, and keep a living record of every application — so the moment a recruiter calls, you are already prepared.

1 Summary

Job seekers now use many tools to get one job. They build a CV in one app, check keywords in a second, track applications in a third, and prepare for interviews in a fourth. The work is split, the AI output often feels generic, and no tool helps at the most stressful moment: when a recruiter calls back weeks later and you cannot remember which CV you sent or what the job was.

Aptly closes that gap. It does two simple things very well, and adds a layer that no competitor owns:

- Tailor with almost no friction. Drop a job post in one box and your CV in the other. Aptly shows exactly what to change and where, with a one-tap “Apply” on each suggestion.
- Keep a living record. Every job post and the CV you actually sent are saved together. You can open any past application in seconds.
- Be ready when they call. One tap opens a Recruiter-Ready Card: the CV you sent, a frozen copy of the job post, why you fit, your talking points, likely questions, and the gaps to expect. This is the feature people will pay for.

Why this can win

Most tools stop at “hit send.” Aptly follows the job seeker through the part that decides the outcome — the recruiter call and the interview — and it does so from one honest profile of real achievements, never invented ones.

The market is crowded but shallow. Rivals compete on keyword match scores that, by their own admission, do not guarantee a callback. Aptly competes on the full journey and on trust. That is the wedge.

WHAT IS ACTUALLY BROKEN

2 The problem and the key insight

Three real pains

- Tailoring is slow and manual. Doing it by hand takes 2–3 hours per role. Sending the same CV to every job is the top reason qualified people get no reply, because each posting uses its own words.
- AI help feels generic. Reviews of the big tools repeatedly say the one-click rewrites sound like every other AI applicant and need heavy editing before they are safe to send.
- The record is a mess. Applications live across email, browser tabs, spreadsheets, and memory. Job posts are often taken down soon after they fill, so the exact wording you applied against simply disappears.

The insight everyone misses

Career coaches already tell people to keep an “application dossier” — one record per job with the CV version sent, the date, the contacts, and the exact job post — and to review it 24 to 48 hours before any call. People are told to save each posting as a PDF because it will vanish. Almost nobody keeps this up by hand. It is dull, and the panic only arrives when the phone rings.

The moment that sells the product

A recruiter calls. You applied five weeks ago. You cannot recall which CV you sent, and the job post is gone from the site. Today you stall and hope. With Aptly, one tap gives you the full picture before you even say hello.

So the product is not “another resume builder.” It is a tailoring tool with a memory, built around the recruiter-call moment and the interview that follows.

Who it is for

Persona	Situation	What they need most
The active applier	Sends 10+ applications a month; juggles many roles at once.	Fast tailoring and a tidy record so nothing gets lost.
The career switcher	Real skills, but the words on the CV do not match the new field.	Honest translation of past work into the new role's language.
The sponsorship seeker	Applying across borders (e.g. UK, Gulf) where each call matters a lot.	To be fully prepared for every screen; no wasted chances.
The passive-but-app roached	Not searching hard, but recruiters reach out now and then.	Instant recall of an old application when a call arrives.

All four share one thing: the cost of being unprepared is high and personal. That is exactly where Aptly earns its keep.

4 Competitor landscape

The space is busy and splits into clear groups. Prices and features below were checked in mid-2026; they move often, so figures are a snapshot, not a promise.

The groups

- ATS keyword scanners. Jobscan is the best-known. You paste a CV and a job post and get a 0–100 match score with missing keywords. Free tier gives about five scans a month; premium is around US\$49.95 a month. It can even name the hiring system a company uses. Common critique: a high score still does not guarantee a callback.
- Per-job tailoring tools. Four-Leaf rebuilds a tailored CV for each post with a match score, at about US\$20 a month or a US\$5 five-day pass. TailoredCV and others sit here too.
- Resume builders. Rezi (about US\$29 a month), Kickresume, Enhancv, and VisualCV focus on nice templates and multiple versions.
- Trackers and light CRM. Teal offers a free tracker, a Chrome clipper, a match scorer, and a contacts CRM (Teal+ around US\$29 a month, or ~US\$15 billed yearly). Simplify autofills forms across 20,000+ career pages and tracks them, used by over a million people (Simplify+ about US\$39.99 a month).
- Auto-apply bots. Tools like JobCopilot and others submit many applications for you, with review before send.
- Interview prep, sold separately. Tools such as Interview Sidekick (about US\$60 a month) or free options like Google Interview Warmup handle practice — usually as a different product you buy on top.

How the tools compare

Full circle = does it well. Half circle = partial or add-on. Empty = not offered.

Tool	Tailor per job	ATS match score	Application tracker	Interview prep	Recruiter-call recall	Truthful story bank
Jobscan						
Teal						
Simplify						
Four-Leaf						
Rezi / VisualCV						
Interview Sidekick						
Aptly (this product)						

What every rival misses

The last two columns are empty for everyone but us. No major tool centres on recruiter-call recall, and none assembles a CV from a bank of your real, reusable achievements. Rivals also break the journey into pieces you must buy separately, and their AI output is widely called generic. Aptly joins the pieces and grounds them in truth.

How we stand out

Positioning statement

For serious job seekers who tailor and track many applications, Aptly is the career copilot that turns one honest profile into a tailored CV, a living record, and full readiness for the recruiter call — all in one place. Unlike keyword scanners and trackers that stop at “send,” Aptly owns the moment the job is actually won or lost.

Four pillars

1. Almost no friction

Drop, see, apply. The core loop is two boxes and a set of one-tap changes. No long forms, no setup wall before the first win.

2. One honest profile, reused

You write each real achievement once into a Story Bank. Aptly assembles tailored CVs from that bank instead of inventing new claims. This kills the “generic AI” problem and keeps every CV true to you.

3. Memory across the whole journey

Tailor, apply, track, get the call, prepare, interview — all connected. The same record that helped you apply is the record that prepares you weeks later.

4. Trust as a feature, not fine print

A clear “no fabrication” promise. Aptly surfaces what you already have and coaches you on honest ways to cover gaps, rather than padding your CV with things you cannot back up in the room.

WHAT WE BUILD FIRST

Core product (the MVP)

The first release delivers exactly the two things a user needs, cleanly.

Feature A — Tailor (the drop-and-apply loop)

- Two drop zones: Job post and Your CV. Both accept paste, or a dropped file (.pdf, .docx, .txt).
- Aptly reads both and returns a short, ranked list of changes. Each change shows the section, the current wording, the suggested wording, and one plain reason tied to the job.
- Every change has an Apply button. Apply-all is one tap. The CV updates live, so you watch the fit improve.
- A keyword coverage meter shows which of the job's key terms your CV already has, and which are still missing — filled naturally, never stuffed.
- Copy or download the tailored CV when done.

Feature B — Library (the living record)

- Save any job post and the exact CV you sent as one application record.
- Aptly stores a frozen snapshot of the job post, because the live posting often disappears.
- Browse or search by company or role. Open any record in seconds.
- Each record keeps the date, the status, and space for the recruiter's name and notes.

Design rule for the MVP

First win before first signup. A new visitor can paste a CV and a job post and see real, useful changes without creating an account. We ask for sign-up only when they want to save a record — the moment the value is obvious.

The features that make it a game changer

These sit on top of the core loop. Each one is chosen because it removes real pain and, together, they are the reason a person upgrades and stays.

Recruiter-Ready Card (the signature)

What it is. One tap on any record opens a single glance-able card built for the call: the CV you sent, the frozen job post, a short “why you fit”, your top talking points, likely questions, the gaps to own, the salary range, and the last contact.

Why people pay. This is the moment no rival serves. It turns panic into confidence and is worth paying for on its own.

Truthful Story Bank

What it is. Write each achievement once, tag it, and reuse it. Aptly builds every tailored CV by picking and rephrasing from this bank.

Why people pay. Removes the “generic AI” problem and keeps every CV honest and consistent.

Honest Gap Coach

What it is. For each missing requirement, Aptly says whether you can bridge it truthfully and gives you the exact sentence or story to use — or flags it as a real gap to acknowledge, not fake.

Why people pay. Coaching people cannot get from a keyword score. Builds trust and real skill.

Interview questions from the job

What it is. From the job post and your CV, Aptly predicts likely phone-screen and behavioural questions, with answer outlines drawn from your Story Bank.

Why people pay. Bundles the interview-prep value that today costs a separate US\$60/month tool.

Human-skim score

What it is. Beyond ATS keywords, a check of whether a recruiter can see the fit in the first six seconds — the crucial top third of page one.

Why people pay. Optimises for the human who decides, not only the software filter.

Version history and diff

What it is. See exactly what changed for each job and roll back if needed.

Why people pay. Confidence and control; never lose a good line.

Follow-up nudges and contact log

What it is. Gentle reminders on when to follow up, plus a simple log of every touch with the recruiter.

Why people pay. Keeps momentum and stops good leads going cold.

Auto-capture (browser clip)

What it is. A one-click clipper saves a job post straight into a record while you browse.

Why people pay. Feeds the living record with near-zero effort.

8 Walkthrough: the Recruiter-Ready Card

Picture the card that opens when the phone rings. Everything a person needs, on one screen, in the order they will use it.

RECRUITER-READY · ACME ROBOTICS	
ROLE	Senior Product Manager · applied 5 weeks ago
CV YOU SENT	Aman_SPM_AcmeRobotics_v3.pdf — open / view
WHY YOU FIT	You led a hardware-plus-software launch and cut ramp time by half — the core of this role.
TALKING POINTS	1) The launch you owned end to end. 2) Cross-team work with design and ops. 3) Metrics you moved.
LIKELY QUESTIONS	“Walk me through a launch that slipped.” · “How do you decide what not to build?”
GAPS TO OWN	Team size was 6, not 10+. Be ready to frame scope honestly and show impact per head.
SALARY RANGE	Market for the role, and your target — ready before they ask.
LAST CONTACT	Recruiter: Priya. Applied 8 Jul. No follow-up yet.

Notice the tone: it does not invent a bigger team or a fake metric. It hands the person the truth about their own application, well organised, plus honest ways to handle the hard parts. That is the whole product in one screen.

HOW IT SHOULD LOOK AND FEEL

9 Design direction

Principle

Calm, trustworthy, and quick. This is a tool people open when they are nervous, so it should feel steady and clear, never loud or salesy. Spend boldness in one place — the Recruiter-Ready Card — and keep everything else quiet.

Colour

Token	Hex	Used for
 Ink	#16181D	Headlines and primary text.
 Paper	#FBFBFA	Calm background, softer than pure white.
 Signal teal-green	#14655C	Primary actions, “ready / verified” states.
 Amber	#C0821F	“Change this” highlights and attention.
 Slate	#5A6270	Secondary text and labels.
 Hairline	#E2E6E8	Quiet dividers and table lines.

This palette is a deliberate choice, not a default. The teal-green reads as “verified and ready,” which fits the promise, and the amber acts like an editor’s highlighter for the exact words to change. Together they avoid the over-used

cream-and-terracotta look and keep a clear job for each colour.

Type

- Display / labels — a geometric sans (Poppins in this document). Confident, friendly, highly legible; right for a mass-market career tool.
- Body — a humanist sans (Carlito here). Comfortable for longer reading.
- Mono — a monospace (Liberation Mono here) for the literal CV text in a “change” card, so the words to edit read as exact, quotable text.

Three voices, three jobs: geometric labels for structure, a calm sans for prose, and mono for the literal lines being changed.

Layout and the signature element

- Two-box hero. The first screen is the drop-and-apply loop itself — the product’s thesis, shown not told.
- Change cards. Each suggestion is a small card: section label, before, after, reason, and one Apply button. This is the everyday texture of the app.
- The Recruiter-Ready Card is the single memorable object. High contrast, one glance, built for a stressful minute. Everything else stays disciplined so this stands out.

Voice and writing

- Plain verbs, sentence case, no filler. Name things by what the person controls (“Apply,” “Save,” “Follow up”).
- An action keeps its name through the whole flow: the button that says “Apply” produces a change that says “Applied.”
- Empty screens invite action; errors say what happened and how to fix it, calmly.

10 Screens and data

Main screens

- Tailor — the two-box loop and the change cards.
- Library — saved application records, search, and open.
- Recruiter-Ready Card — the call view, reachable from any record.
- Story Bank — your reusable, tagged achievements.
- Prep — predicted questions and answer outlines for a chosen role.
- Profile & settings — base CV, preferences, privacy controls.

Core data model

Entity	Holds	Why it matters
Profile	Base details, preferences, target roles.	The single source everything is built from.
Story item	One real achievement, tagged by skill and theme.	Lets Aptly assemble true CVs instead of inventing.
Job record	Company, role, status, dates, and a frozen job-post snapshot.	Survives the posting being taken down.
CV version	The exact file sent, plus the change history / diff.	Answers “which CV did I send?” instantly.
Contact	Recruiter name, notes, and every touch.	Powers follow-ups and the call view.
Prep set	Predicted questions and answer outlines for a role.	Turns a record into interview readiness.

DOING IT RESPONSIBLY

11 Trust, truth, and privacy

- No fabrication. Aptly never adds a skill or job you do not have. It rephrases and surfaces what is real, and clearly marks any suggestion you must confirm.
- Honesty over score-gaming. We do not chase a perfect keyword score with stuffing. We aim for a strong, natural fit and an honest gap plan.
- Your data is personal. CVs, contacts, and notes are private to the user, with plain controls to export or delete everything.
- You stay in control. Nothing is sent anywhere on your behalf without a clear, reviewed action.

HOW IT MAKES MONEY

12 Business model

Free	Pro	Week Pass
US\$0	~US\$16 / month	~US\$5 / 7 days

A few tailorings a month. Basic records you save by hand. Enough to feel the value.

Unlimited tailoring, Story Bank, auto-records, Gap Coach, interview questions, follow-up nudges, and the Recruiter-Ready Card.

Everything in Pro for one urgent search — for people with a single big application this week.

This deliberately undercuts the keyword scanners (around US\$50 a month) and the autofill tools (around US\$40 a month), and matches the per-job tailoring tools (around US\$20), while offering more of the journey. The US\$5 week pass copies a model that already works in this market and captures one-off, high-intent users.

HOW WE KNOW IT WORKS

13 Success metrics

- Activation: a new visitor completes one tailoring in the first session.
- Core value: tailorings per active user per week, and time from drop to a finished CV.
- The moat metric: how often people open a Recruiter-Ready Card, and how many records they keep.
- Outcome: self-reported interviews and offers per user over time.
- Business: free-to-Pro conversion, week-pass sales, and month-3 retention.

ORDER OF BUILDING

14 Roadmap

Phase	Focus	Key work
1 • Core	Prove the loop.	Drop-and-apply tailoring; keyword meter; save records with frozen job-post snapshot; search.
2 • Moat	The reasons to pay.	Story Bank; Recruiter-Ready Card; Gap Coach; interview questions; version diff.
3 • Reach	Lower friction further.	Browser clipper; follow-up nudges and contact log; human-skim score; mobile polish.
4 • Depth	Grow with the user.	Salary prep; multiple profiles; sharing; integrations with common job boards.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG, AND THE ANSWER

15 Risks and how we handle them

Risk	Our answer
AI output feels generic	Build CVs from the user's own Story Bank, and always keep a human review step before send.
Truthfulness	A hard “no fabrication” rule; clearly mark anything the user must confirm.
Match scores don't equal callbacks	Add a human-skim score and honest gap coaching, so we optimise for the person, not only the filter.
Crowded market	Own the recall-and-interview part of the journey that rivals ignore; compete on trust and completeness.
Privacy worry	Private by default, with plain export and delete controls.

A note on the name

"Aptly" is a working name (it hints at a good, apt fit). Other options that fit the recruiter-call angle: Callback, Ready Room, or Dossier. Worth testing before launch.

WHERE THE MARKET FACTS CAME FROM

16 Sources

Competitor features and prices were checked on the web in mid-2026 and are a snapshot only. Main pages used:

- VisualCV — best resume tailoring tools (visualcv.com/blog)
- FastApply — best AI resume tailoring tools 2026 (blog.fastapply.co)
- Four-Leaf — best AI resume tailoring tool 2026 (four-leaf.ai/blog)
- Teal reviews (loopcv.pro, ophyai.com, rezi.ai)
- Simplify reviews (tooldirectory.ai, resumehog.com, autoapplier.com)
- Jobscan reviews and pricing (jobbright.ai, jobsolv.com, makerstack.co, careery.pro)
- Jobscan blog — AI job search tools workflow (jobscan.co/blog)
- Recruiter-screen prep and application dossier advice (9tothrive.substack.com, vervecopilot.com)
- Resume and application mistakes (interviewfocus.com, stylingcv.com)